

“All the News  
That’s Fit to Print”

# The New York Times

**THE WEATHER**  
Today, mostly sunny, light winds, high 82. **Tonight**, clear and variable winds, low 66. **Tomorrow**, mostly sunny, light winds out of the east, high 82. Weather map, Page B10.

VOL. CLXXV . . . No. 60,955

© 2026 The New York Times Company

FRIDAY, JULY 24, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



ASIM HAFEEZ FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

**Ready for Peace, Open for Business**  
Business owners in Pakistan have been growing impatient for a chance to resume trade along their long border with Iran. Page A4.

## U.S. Dropping Its Subpoenas Against Times

By MICHAEL M. GRYNBAUM and JONAH E. BROMWICH

The Justice Department on Thursday withdrew the subpoenas that sought phone records and grand jury testimony from New York Times journalists who had reported on the security capabilities of President Trump’s new Qatari-donated Air Force One jet.

The government acted after a federal judge grilled Justice Department lawyers for nearly an hour over their handling of the subpoenas, which The Times had sought to quash. The news outlet called the subpoenas an effort to intimidate its reporters.

Judge Arun Subramanian, at a hearing in U.S. District Court in Manhattan, said the government was not prevented from subpoenaing the Times reporters again if it followed appropriate procedures.

The case was a high-profile instance of the Trump administration’s efforts to escalate pressure on independent news organizations. The government issued the subpoenas, some of which were delivered by federal agents at reporters’ homes, after Mr. Trump was angered by The Times’s disclosures about his new jet, which he had flown to Turkey this month and eagerly showed off.

Shortly after The Times published its reporting, the White House instructed Kash Patel, the director of the Federal Bureau of Investigation, to pursue a leak investigation to unmask confidential sources who had provided information to the newspaper about

Continued on Page A13

## A Daring Escape From a ‘Prison Without Bars’

By CHOE SANG-HUN

SEOUL — Rain lashed a flimsy wooden boat as it tossed through a churning sea, its engine straining against the swell. Under the cover of a stormy night three years ago, the vessel was fleeing North Korea.

On board were nine people, including two small children and a woman who was six months pregnant. Only a couple of the passengers had seafaring experience. They eluded a patrol ship, speeding across the world’s most heavily guarded maritime border.

Soon after their boat lurched into South Korean waters, a high-speed warship of the South’s navy bore down on it, tearing the water

### Korean Kin, on Stormy Night, Fled by Sea to the South

in aggressive circles. Snipers on the vessel trained their laser sights on the chests of the three adult men on the wooden boat.

Through a loudspeaker, a voice boomed: “Are you lost? Engine trouble?”

The North Koreans shouted: “Please help. We are defecting.”

The red dots remained stubbornly fixed on their chests. The South Koreans were taking no chances: The three men were clad in North Korean military uni-

forms, camouflage for a high-stakes escape. Desperate, the men shouted into the boat’s cramped hold for the other passengers to emerge in order to prove that they were civilians. From below, the two children, a 5-year-old girl and 3-year-old boy, were hauled up first, both pale and wasted from seasickness. Only then did the red dots drop off.

The North Koreans, led by Kim Il-hyeok and his younger brother, Yi-hyeok, were bound together by blood and marriage. The brothers, both in their 30s at the time, were accompanied by their mother and their families: Il-hyeok’s partner, who was pregnant, and Yi-hyeok’s wife, their two children, and his mother-in-law and brother-in-law.

Continued on Page A10



WOOHAE CHO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Kim Yu-mi, a North Korean defector, at the entrance to her mother’s apartment in Seoul in June.

## F.D.A. Advisers Dismiss Peptide Fears. Some of Them Are Sellers.

By CHRISTINA JEWETT and DANA G. SMITH

A panel of advisers to the Food and Drug Administration, several of them sellers of experimental peptides, dismissed the concerns of the agency’s scientists on Thursday, voting in favor of allowing broad production of poorly understood peptide treatments.

Near the end of the first day of a two-day meeting, votes on three different peptide products had an

identical tally of 8 to 6 in favor of allowing specialized pharmacies to produce and sell peptide treatments. Votes on three more peptides are scheduled for Friday.

The votes were nonbinding, but they were a rebuke to F.D.A. scientists, who said the risks and benefits of the peptide drugs under consideration had not been sufficiently studied.

Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., who oversees the F.D.A., has long supported lifting restrictions on peptides. In the weeks be-

### Panel Backs Wider Use of 3 Disputed Drugs

fore Thursday’s hearing, his office nominated eight new members to the committee of academics and doctors that would review the issue, six of whom have sold peptide products, some banned, with health claims backed by minimal science.

“I think we have seen an extraordinary abuse of the advisory committee process to secure ends that have no basis in science,” said Dr. Peter Lurie, president of the Center for Science in the Public Interest.

The specific issue before the committee was whether the F.D.A. should allow specialized pharmacies to produce seven peptide products that the agency banned three years ago over safety con-

Continued on Page A12



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

### Russia’s Retail Pillar Targeted

Kyiv has been striking commercial warehouses, trying to bring the conflict closer to home for Russians. PAGE A8

### Japan’s Nationalist Shift

The prime minister is leveraging her ties to Shinzo Abe, the slain leader, as she tries to reshape the nation. PAGE A9

BUSINESS B1-5

### Pulling Back From Open Web

As Google incorporates more A.I. into search, people are spending more time on Google. Some are crying foul. PAGE B1

### Investors Bet Oil Costs Will Fall

Futures contracts reflect an expectation that low supplies and midterm elections may lead to easing tensions. PAGE B1

OBITUARIES A20

### A Nobel-Winning Scientist

Susumu Tonegawa, 86, a molecular biologist, showed how the body makes antibodies to fight infections. He also discovered how memories are stored.



NATIONAL A11-17

### Expensive Storm Rebuilding

Recovering from climate change’s effects will cost an estimated \$519 billion in New York in the next 24 years. PAGE A11

### Minnesota Gunman Gets Life

Vance Boelter killed a lawmaker and her husband, and shot another lawmaker and the man’s wife. PAGE A17

SPORTS B6-10

### Embracing the Spotlight

Between his success and controversies, Tarik Skubal is no stranger to attention. With M.L.B.’s trade deadline looming, the Tigers’ ace will once again be a main character. PAGE B6

### Stars of the Irregular Season

N.B.A. Summer League performances are tricky to evaluate, but 12 players — including Cameron Boozer, AJ Dybantsa and Caleb Wilson — showed skills that should translate to real games. PAGE B9

OPINION A18-19

### Josh Lipsky

PAGE A18



WEEKEND ARTS C1-8

### Her Own Talent on Display

Betty Parsons, who showed works of “great big shots” in her gallery starting in the 1940s, now has some of her creations on view at Bard College. PAGE C6

